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Airbnb

Dear Airbnb Team,

I am applying for the iOS Engineer role on Airbnb's Payments and Insurance Engineering team. My career has focused on building high-trust, high-reliability mobile systems at scale, and the mission of powering trusted financial and protection experiences for a global marketplace strongly aligns with the work I have led and the problems I most enjoy solving.

Most recently, I serve as a Principal Software Engineer at Walmart, leading the iOS Checkout team, where I own iOS platform architecture and delivery for one of the highest-volume consumer transaction systems in the world. My role spans technical strategy, system design, and hands-on development across complex checkout and payments flows supporting millions of daily users. I partner closely with product, design, backend, and data teams to translate business and trust requirements into scalable, resilient mobile solutions. Correctness, observability, and reliability are not abstract goals in this environment—they directly affect revenue, security, and customer confidence.

My technical background maps closely to the needs of this role. I have extensive experience with Swift and Objective-C, building and evolving large UIKit codebases while introducing SwiftUI for new development. I have architected unidirectional, reactive mobile systems focused on performance, testability, and long-term maintainability, and I bring deep production experience integrating GraphQL APIs, collaborating on schema design, and evolving mobile-optimized data contracts. I have also led automated testing initiatives (unit, integration, and UI), CI/CD practices, and production-readiness efforts to support rapid iteration without sacrificing stability.

I consistently operate as a technical leader and cross-functional partner. At Walmart, I help define and enforce iOS engineering standards, mentor engineers across multiple teams, and lead design and code reviews for business-critical features. I am comfortable working in ambiguous problem spaces, shaping solutions alongside product and design, and making pragmatic tradeoffs that balance speed to value with long-term platform health. I am particularly motivated by work where engineering quality directly strengthens user trust—an outcome that sits at the core of Airbnb's payments and protection experiences.

This opportunity presents engineering challenges I am well equipped to contribute to: complex integrations, evolving financial products, and mobile experiences where reliability, performance, and UX quality are inseparable. I would welcome the opportunity to bring my background in large-scale mobile systems, payments-adjacent workflows, and technical leadership to help advance Airbnb's platform.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I look forward to the opportunity to discuss how my experience could support Airbnb's Payments and Insurance Engineering team.

Sincerely,
Doug Sjoquist